

Reporting Verbs for All Types of Interrogative Sentences

प्रत्यक्ष तथा अप्रत्यक्ष कथनमा Interrogative Sentences का Reporting Verbs

An interrogative sentence may express a simple question, inquiry, curiosity, doubt, investigation, request for information, surprise, confirmation, or rhetorical questioning.

1. Asking a General Question — सामान्य प्रश्न

When someone simply asks a question without any special emotion or purpose.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
asked	सोधे
questioned	प्रश्न गरे
inquired	सोधपुछ गरे
wanted to know	जान्न चाहे

Example

Direct: He said to me, “Where do you live?”

Indirect: He **asked me where I lived.**

Nepali: उसले मलाई म कहाँ बस्छु भनेर सोध्यो।

☆ **Asked** is the most common reporting verb for ordinary questions.

2. Yes/No Question — हो/होइनमा उत्तर आउने प्रश्न

These questions normally begin with **Is, Are, Am, Was, Were, Do, Does, Did, Have, Has, Had, Can, Will, etc.**

Suitable reporting verbs:

- **asked**
- **inquired**
- **wanted to know**
- **questioned**

Example

Direct: She said to me, “Are you ready?”

Indirect: She **asked me if/whether I was ready.**

Nepali: उनले मलाई म तयार छु कि छैन भनेर सोधिन्।

Structure

Subject + asked + object + if/whether + subject + verb

“Do you like tea?”

→ He **asked me if** I liked tea.

3. WH-Question — Wh-प्रश्न

Questions beginning with:

What, Who, Whom, Whose, Which, When, Where, Why, How, How many, How much, How long, How often, etc.

Reporting verbs

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
asked	सोधे
inquired	सोधपुछ गरे
questioned	प्रश्न गरे
wanted to know	जान्न चाहे

wondered	जान्न उत्सुक/अचम्मित भए
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Example

Direct: He said to me, “Why are you late?”

Indirect: He **asked me why I was late.**

Nepali: उसले मलाई म किन ढिलो भएको थिएँ भनेर सोध्यो।

Important rule

With a **WH-question**, do **not** use *if/whether*.

✗ He asked me **if why** I was late.

✓ He asked me **why** I was late.

4. Inquiry — सोधपुछ/जानकारी खोज्नु

Used when someone formally seeks information.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
inquired	सोधपुछ गरे
asked	सोधे
investigated	अनुसन्धान गरे

questioned	प्रश्न गरे
sought to know	जान्न खोजे

Example

Direct: The officer said to him, “Where were you last night?”

Indirect: The officer **inquired where he had been** the previous night.

Nepali: अधिकृतले ऊ अघिल्लो रात कहाँ थियो भनेर सोधपुछ गरे।

5. Formal Inquiry — औपचारिक सोधपुछ

Used in official, academic, legal, or professional situations.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
inquired	औपचारिक रूपमा सोधपुछ गरे
questioned	प्रश्न गरे
interrogated	कडा/औपचारिक सोधपुछ गरे
investigated	अनुसन्धान गरे
sought information	जानकारी खोजे

Example

Direct: The officer said, “Where were you going?”

Indirect: The officer **questioned him about where he was going.**

Interrogated is stronger than *asked* and is generally associated with serious or official questioning.

6. Curiosity — जिज्ञासा

When the speaker asks because they are curious.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wondered	जान्न उत्सुक भए/अचम्म माने
was curious to know	जान्न जिज्ञासु भए
wanted to know	जान्न चाहे
asked	सोधे

Example

Direct: She said, “What will happen next?”

Indirect: She **wondered what would happen** next.

Nepali: अब के हुन्छ भनेर उनी जिज्ञासु भइन्।

7. Doubt — शंका

When a question expresses uncertainty or doubt.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
doubted	शंका गरे
questioned	शंका व्यक्त गर्दै प्रश्न गरे
wondered	सोच्दै/शंका गर्दै जान्न चाहे
was uncertain	अनिश्चित थिए

Example

Direct: He said, “Will they really help us?”

Indirect: He **wondered whether they would really help** them.

Nepali: उनीहरूले साँच्चै सहयोग गर्छन् कि गर्दैनन् भनेर उसले शंका गर्‍यो।

8. Confirmation — पुष्टि गर्न खोज्नु

When someone asks to confirm whether something is true.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
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asked for confirmation	पुष्टि मागे
sought confirmation	पुष्टि खोजे
checked	जाँच गरे
verified	यकिन/प्रमाणित गरे
wanted to confirm	पुष्टि गर्न चाहे

Example

Direct: He said, “Is the meeting really tomorrow?”

Indirect: He **asked whether the meeting was really the next day.**

9. Asking for Information — जानकारी माग्न

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
asked	सोधे
inquired	जानकारीका लागि सोधपुछ गरे
wanted to know	जान्न चाहे
sought information about	बारेमा जानकारी खोजे

Example

Direct: The tourist said, “Where is the railway station?”

Indirect: The tourist **inquired where the railway station was**.

10. Asking About a Person — व्यक्तिको बारेमा सोध्नु

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
asked about	बारेमा सोधे
inquired about	बारेमा सोधपुछ गरे
wanted to know about	बारेमा जान्न चाहे

Example

Direct: She said, “How is your father?”

Indirect: She **asked about my father**.

Nepali: उनले मेरो बुबाको अवस्थाबारे सोधिन्।

11. Asking About a Thing — वस्तु/कुराको बारेमा सोध्नु

Direct: He said, “What is this?”

Indirect: He **asked what that was.**

Other verbs:

- **inquired about** — बारेमा सोधपुछ गरे
- **wanted to know about** — बारेमा जान्न चाहे
- **questioned** — प्रश्न गरे

12. Asking for Reason — कारण सोध्नु

Usually with **why**.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
asked why	किन भनेर सोधे
inquired why	किन भनेर सोधपुछ गरे
wanted to know why	किन भनेर जान्न चाहे
questioned why	किन भनेर प्रश्न गरे

Example

Direct: Mother said to me, “Why are you crying?”

Indirect: Mother **asked me why I was crying.**

13. Asking About Time — समय सोध्नु

Direct: He said, “When will you return?”

Indirect: He **asked me when I would return.**

Possible verbs:

- **asked**
- **inquired**
- **wanted to know**

14. Asking About Place — स्थान सोध्नु

Direct: She said, “Where are you going?”

Indirect: She **asked me where I was going.**

15. Asking About Method — तरिका सोध्नु

Usually with **How.**

Direct: He said, “How did you solve the problem?”

Indirect: He **asked me how I had solved** the problem.

16. Asking About Quantity / Number — मात्रा वा सङ्ख्या

Direct: He said, “How many students are there?”

Indirect: He **asked how many students there were**.

Direct: She said, “How much money do you need?”

Indirect: She **asked how much money I needed**.

17. Asking for Choice — छनोट सोध्नु

Usually with **which / whether...or**.

Direct: He said, “Which book do you want?”

Indirect: He **asked me which book I wanted**.

Direct: She said, “Will you take tea or coffee?”

Indirect: She **asked me whether I would take tea or coffee**.

18. Rhetorical Question — आलंकारिक प्रश्न

A rhetorical question is not necessarily asked to obtain an actual answer. It may express **anger, surprise, criticism, doubt, or emphasis**.

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wondered	अचम्म/जिज्ञासा व्यक्त गरे
questioned	प्रश्न/शंका व्यक्त गरे
asked rhetorically	आलंकारिक रूपमा प्रश्न गरे
exclaimed	उद्गार व्यक्त गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “Who can believe such a story?”

Indirect: He **wondered who could believe** such a story.

19. Angry Question — रिस/क्रोध व्यक्त गर्ने प्रश्न

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
demanded to know	कडा रूपमा जान्न माग गरे
questioned angrily	रिसाउँदै प्रश्न गरे
demanded	कडा रूपमा माग गरे

challenged	चुनौती दिँदै प्रश्न गरे
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Example

Direct: The father said, “Why did you do this?”

Indirect: The father **demanded to know why** he had done that.

20. Surprised Question — आश्चर्य व्यक्त गर्ने प्रश्न

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
wondered	अचम्म माने
expressed surprise	आश्चर्य व्यक्त गरे
asked in surprise	आश्चर्यका साथ सोधे
exclaimed in surprise	आश्चर्यका साथ उद्गार गरे

Example

Direct: She said, “How did he win the competition?”

Indirect: She **wondered how he had won** the competition.

21. Challenging Question — चुनौतीपूर्ण प्रश्न

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
challenged	चुनौती दिँदै प्रश्न गरे
questioned	चुनौती/शंका गर्दै प्रश्न गरे
demanded to know	कडा रूपमा जान्न माग गरे

Example

Direct: He said, “Can you prove it?”

Indirect: He **challenged me to prove** it.

Here, **challenged + object + to + V1** is appropriate because the question is actually a challenge.

22. Demanding an Answer — उत्तरको माग

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
demanded to know	कडा रूपमा जान्न माग गरे
demanded an explanation	स्पष्टीकरण माग गरे
insisted on knowing	जान्न जोड दिए

Example

Direct: The teacher said, “Why are you late?”

Indirect: The teacher **demanded to know why** I was late.

☆ Master Classification

Meaning of Question	Best Reporting Verbs
सामान्य प्रश्न	asked, questioned
जानकारी मागु	asked, inquired, wanted to know
Yes/No question	asked, inquired, wanted to know
WH-question	asked, inquired, wanted to know
औपचारिक सोधपुछ	inquired, questioned
गम्भीर/कडा सोधपुछ	interrogated, questioned
जिज्ञासा	wondered, was curious to know
शंका	doubted, wondered, questioned
पुष्टि	asked, wanted to confirm, sought confirmation
रिस	demanded to know, questioned angrily

आश्चर्य	wondered, expressed surprise
चुनौती	challenged
आलंकारिक प्रश्न	wondered, questioned, asked rhetorically
स्पष्टीकरण माग्न	demanded an explanation
व्यक्ति/वस्तुको बारेमा	asked about, inquired about

Structures to Remember

A. WH-Interrogative

Subject + asked + object + WH-word + Subject + Verb

“Where do you live?”

→ He asked me where I lived.

Nepali: उसले मलाई म कहाँ बस्छु भनेर सोध्यो।

B. Yes/No Interrogative

Subject + asked + object + if/whether + Subject + Verb

“Are you happy?”

→ He asked me whether I was happy.

C. Question expressing doubt

Subject + wondered/doubted + whether/if + clause

“Will he come?”

→ She **wondered whether he would come.**

D. Question expressing a challenge

Subject + challenged + object + to + V1

“Can you solve this problem?”

→ He **challenged me to solve** the problem.

E. Demand for information

Subject + demanded to know + WH-clause / whether-clause

“Where have you been?”

→ The father **demanded to know where** his son had been.

 **Golden Rule**

For **Interrogative Sentences**, never choose the reporting verb only from the grammatical form of the question. Choose it from the **speaker's intention**:

Simple question → asked

Information → inquired

Curiosity → wondered

Doubt → doubted/wondered

Formal questioning → questioned

Serious questioning → interrogated

Anger/demand → demanded to know

Challenge → challenged

Confirmation → wanted to know/asked whether

Rhetorical purpose → wondered/questioned